Dominic Farr

Hands-On Engineering Leadership

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SUMMARY

Hands-on engineering leader with 15+ years building and running small, high-trust product teams and staying active in the codebase. Built Policy Expert's insurance platform from zero to $200M GWP, scaling the team 6→40, migrated from monolith to distributed event base services. More recently, as technical founder, shipping a B2B SaaS platform (TypeScript, React, Python, NLP) from PoC to Production software. Comfortable owning delivery with scrum and kanban.

CORE SKILLS

Agentic & AI Development · MCP · Python · Java · TypeScript · JavaScript · Svelte · Spec Driven · AWS · Docker · CI/CD · Event-Driven Architecture · Microservices · Observability · B2B SaaS delivery · Stakeholder collaboration · Team hiring, coaching & mentoring · Agile · Kanban

EXPERIENCE

Independent Consulting & Advisory — Halifax, NS Mar *2026 – Present*

- Organism (independent dev collective): led technical scoping and prototyping on an AI-driven automation pitch for a progressive local construction company in Halifax.
- Startup advisor and weekly mentor to fromearth.co, a founding team building in the consumer/sustainability space.
- Hands-on with agentic workflows and LLM-assisted development tooling.

Co-Founder — Flowstate, Halifax, NS & London, UK *Dec 2023 – Nov 2025*

- Owned architecture and technical delivery of a B2B SaaS platform end-to-end, from proof-of-concept through beta and early customer onboarding — sole technical lead.
- Built the full stack: TypeScript/React frontend, Python APIs, NLP services, containerised deployment, CI/CD pipelines.
- Ran sprint execution and release management directly; triaged and resolved production issues as they arose.
- Led architectural discovery with early customers, translating business workflows into product and data models.

Hands-On Engineering & Technical Advisory — Independent, Canada *Aug 2020 – Dec 2023*

- Delivered principal-level architectural and hands-on engineering support to founders across fintech, healthtech, and digital publishing — greenfield builds and remediation of struggling systems.
- Mentored early-career and graduate engineers embedded in client teams, improving delivery standards and architectural consistency.

Head of Technology — Policy Expert, London, UK *Jul 2013 – Dec 2019*

- Led architecture and teams for a regulated cloud-native insurance platform handling $200M+ gross written premium; #1-rated conversion on price comparison sites, 73% renewal retention.
- Scaled engineering from 6 to 40 across 7 teams; drove developer retention to 3x the London average. Directed a microservices/event-driven transformation: 100+ production services, near-zero high-priority downtime across seven years.
- Managed a $5M+ annual technology budget; cut hiring costs by $400K/year via a blended remote/local hiring strategy.

Lead Developer — Policy Expert, London, UK*Jul 2010 – Jul 2013*

- Lead team that designed and built the insurance platform, obtained regulatory approval; Established technology strategy and tooling roadmap, empowering business units to iterate independently and freeing hundreds of developer hours.
- Introduced automation, DevOps, CI, and established fast feedback loops for faster iterations with higher quality.

Additional Experience — Lead Developer, Informa · Senior Developer, Riptown / Bodog Media *2006 – 2010*

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MSc Computer Science — University of Bristol, UK · BSc Biological Sciences — UWE Bristol, UK
Build AI Agents using MCP (IBM) · Python Programming (Microsoft) · Professional Scrum Master (PSM I)